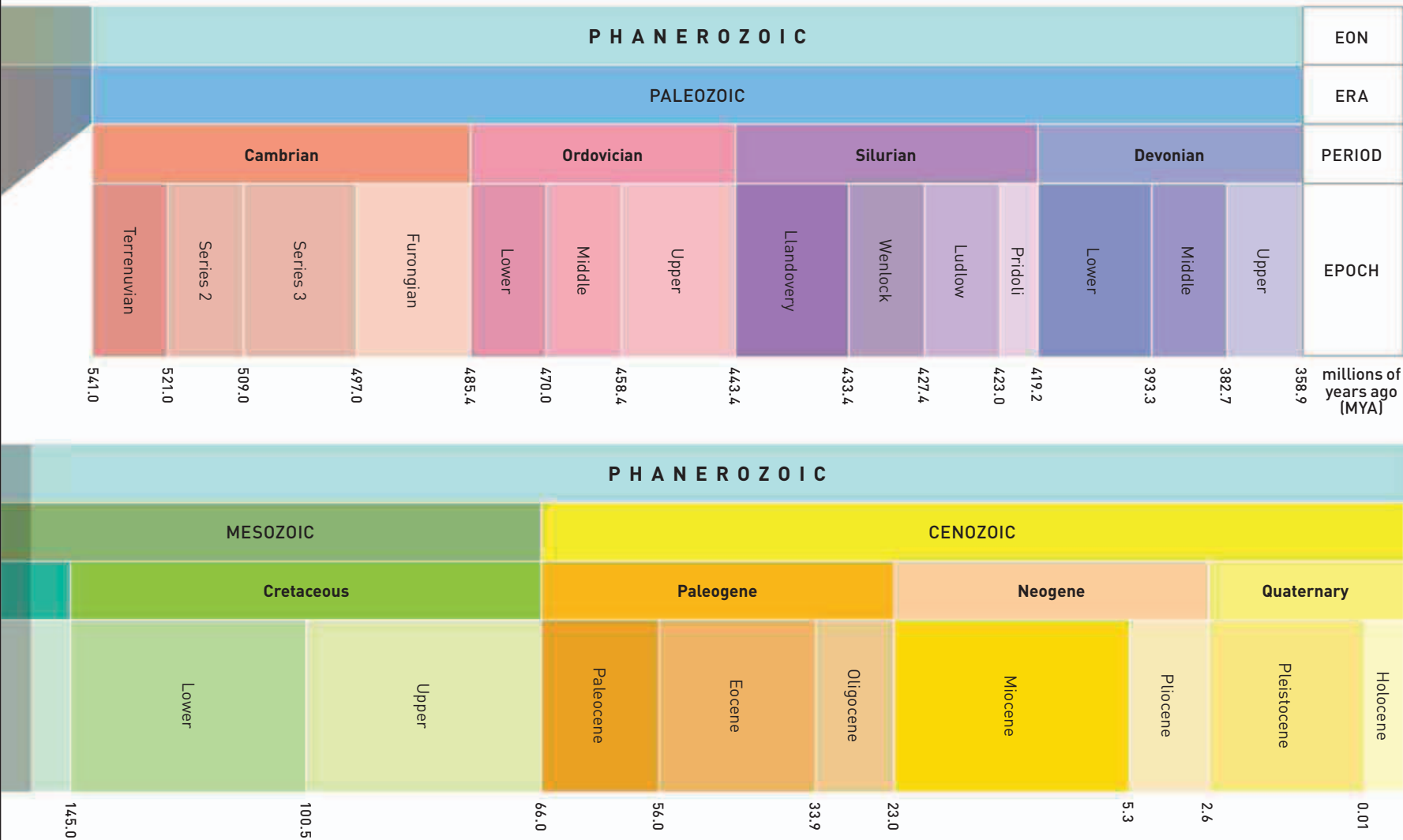
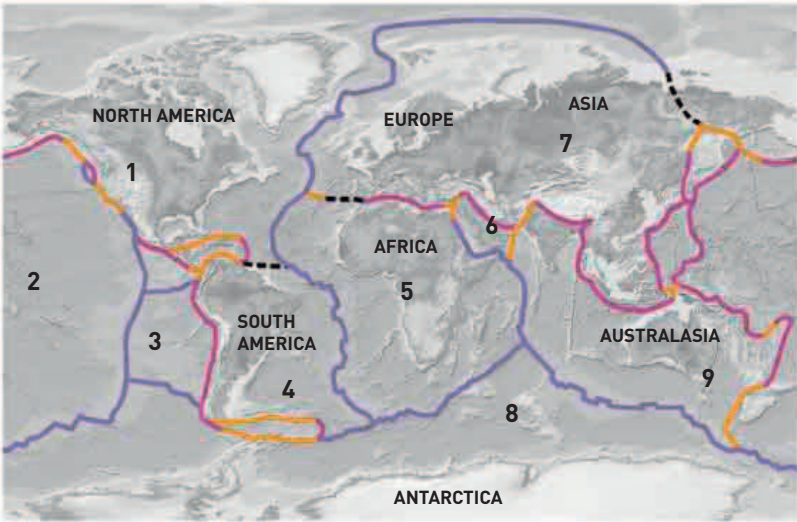




TECTONIC PLATES

Earth's lithosphere (its crust and uppermost mantle) is divided into nine major tectonic plates, about six or seven medium-sized plates, and numerous much smaller plates called microplates.

The boundaries between the plates are of three different types: divergent, where the plates have moved apart; convergent, where they have moved together; and transform, where plates slide past one another along fault planes. The movement of divergent and convergent plates has shifted continents, open and closed oceans, and formed mountains.



- MAJOR TECTONIC PLATES**
- 1 North American Plate
 - 2 Pacific Plate
 - 3 Nazca Plate
 - 4 South American Plate
 - 5 African Plate
 - 6 Arabian Plate
 - 7 Eurasian Plate
 - 8 Antarctic Plate
 - 9 Indo-Australian Plate

- KEY**
- Convergent
 - Divergent
 - Transform
 - Uncertain